REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT IN FAVOR TO MEASURE O

Measure O supporters are asking voters to renew a 3/4-cent sales tax extension because public safety needs continued funding, especially paramedic services. But the central issue is not whether Rio Vista values public safety, it's whether this is the best and most responsible way to fund a growing budget gap.

Supporters say renewing Measure O "will NOT increase local taxes" because it is an extension. However, an extension still means residents will continue paying the sales tax now and in the future. If the city's general fund (excluding Measure O) has declined while public safety costs have risen, that points to a structural funding problem that should be addressed through spending reductions, staffing efficiencies, or other targeted funding, not simply renewed consumption taxes.

The projected deficits ($341,250 in 2026–27 and $1,398,000 in 2027–28) are forecasts. Voters deserve transparent, line-by-line budget explanations of what will happen if Measure O is not renewed. What alternatives were considered, and how the city plans to close gaps without further tax reliance.

Claims that "all funds will remain within the City" do not guarantee effectiveness. Local control does not prevent budget shifting, and it does not ensure that Measure O dollars will maintain staffing levels rather than replacing other spending.

Prior voter support in 2020 doesn't resolve the question for 2027 onward: whether the city can demonstrate accountability, clear service commitments, and responsible long-term budgeting.

Can you really trust them? VOTE NO ON MEASURE O.

Solano County Taxpayers Association
s/Michael T Nolan, President